Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

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Pre-Completion OPT

Jump to a Section

What Is Pre-Completion OPT?

Pre-Completion Optional Practical Training (OPT) is a type of employment authorization that allows F-1 students to gain practical work experience **during** their academic program (i.e., before the program end date listed on the Form I-20). It is one of three types of Optional Practical Training available to USC students.

Employment must be directly related to the student's major field of study at USC. The student is required to maintain F-1 status and report to OIS during the Pre-Completion OPT period.

The Pre-Completion OPT application will rec recommendation on page 3 issued by OIS be 765 to USCIS.

Time used for Pre-Completion OPT is deduct Completion eligibility after graduation.

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- Must consult with an OIS advisor to determine eligibility.
- Are not required to have a job offer.

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How to Apply for Pre-Completion OPT

The Pre-Completion OPT application process must be completed in the following order:

1. Student meets with an OIS advisor to determine eligibility.
2. Student submits Pre-Completion OPT I-20 Request in Trojan International.
3. Student receives Pre-Completion OPT I-20 from OIS via USC email.
4. Student files Form I-765 and uploads signed Pre-Completion OPT I-20 and supporting documents to USCIS.
5. USCIS adjudicates the student's Pre-Co
6. If approved, student receives USCIS app Authorization Document (EAD) by USPS
7. Student begins working on or after the working when the EAD expires.

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How to Request a Pre-Completion OPT From OIS

Receiving the Pre-Completion OPT I-20 from OIS

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Filing the Form I-765

After receiving the Pre-Completion OPT I-20 from OIS, students must file Form I-765 online via their myUSCIS account. If the student does not have an account with USCIS, they must create one.

Important Deadline Considerations

Before You File

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797C Notice of Action: Receipt." This includes a receipt number, which they can use to check their case status.

Sample USCIS Receipt Notice:

Receipt Number	USCIS Online Account Number	Case Type
IOE[redacted]	[redacted]	I765 - APPLICATION FOR EMPLOYMENT AUTHORIZATION
Received Date	**Priority Date**	**Applicant**
02/01/2026	02/01/2026	[redacted]
Notice Date	**Page**	
02/01/2026	1 of 2	

[redacted]

Notice Type: Premium Processing Receipt Notice
Amount received: $2155.00 U.S.
Class requested: C03A

Thank you for choosing to use the U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services' Premium Processing service. We have received the application ("your case") listed above and accepted it as a Premium Processing case. You should receive a notice regarding your case within 30 business days from the date shown as the "Received Date" above. If we need to contact you regarding your case, we may do so by mail, telephone, facsimile, or e-mail using the information you provided.

Here is an example of a receipt notice, which includes a receipt number used to check your case status.

As USCIS processing times vary and it can ta[illegible]ed, we recommend that the student check current e[illegible]. Select Form I-765, then choose the appropriate form cate[illegible]receipt notice.

[illegible]filed the Form I-907, Request for Premi[illegible]onse within 30 business days, not including weekends or holidays. Please note that attending the required biometrics

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Maintaining F-1 Status While on OPT

General Pre-Completion OPT Requirements

Pre-Completion OPT Reporting Requirements

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Travel and Reentry to the United States While on OPT

Please refer to our requirements for reentry page to learn more

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649 West 34th St.
Los Angeles, CA 90089-1626

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